

starseq - music from the stars

An 8-track sequencer that reads its notes from the sky.

The sky is the score

Each of the 8 tracks watches a **slice of sky** - an arc of azimuth with a centre and a width. Only stars inside a track's slice, and bright enough to pass its threshold, can sound on that track. As the sky turns, the sequence rebuilds.

A slice splits into as many step-wedges as the track's **length**. When several stars share a step, **play mode** picks which sound (random, highest/lowest, brightest/dimmest...). **Mono** keeps one; **poly** keeps many.

Anywhere, any when, any speed

The device knows where it is using GPS, and uses that to calculate the visible stars. You can manually set this to any lat/lon - or pick from a list of presets - and automatically travel to that location!

The sky runs on a simulated clock. The **time multiplier** can speed it up, freeze it, or reverse it, without ever jumping. A long-press on the encoder snaps it back to the real moment. Or you can set the time to a significant event and experience what the stars sounded like then.

Instant space and time travel at the turn of a dial!

Star properties → musical parameters

STAR	TRACK/STEP/NOTE
Altitude height above horizon	Pitch, within scale & note range
Azimuth angle from slice center	Step position
B–V colour index blue → red	Note duration
Magnitude apparent brightness	Velocity, and the slice brightness gate

The skydome

Represents a polar plot of the sky: zenith at centre, horizon at the edge, north at top. Stars pulse on a note-on. Planets are hexagon markers - and are visual only, not sequenced. View modes sets how brightly this is all drawn.

Musical - or not

The user can apply tempo, scale and key constraints, with which to constrain the generation of musical notes and steps. Or chromatic mode can be applied for some chaos!

Tempo can be set externally, or can be sent out from the sequencer to other midi devices.

starseq - controller

emfv1

